

Thomas Leavitt

ASSISTANT PROFESSOR

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Baruch College, City University of New York (CUNY) Assistant Professor (tenure track), Marx School of Public and International Affairs Affiliate, CUNY Institute for Demographic Research (CIDR)	2023 -
Harvard University Postdoctoral Research Fellow, Harvard Medical School	2021 - 2023

AFFILIATIONS

Arnold Ventures Criminal Justice Evaluation Network Evaluation and Evidence Consulting Fellow	2026 -
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EDUCATION

Columbia University Political Science <i>Dissertation:</i> "Design-based, Bayesian Causal Inference for the Social Sciences" <i>Committee:</i> Donald P. Green (chair), Macartan Humphreys (sponsor), Naoki Egami, Jake Bowers (external, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign), Fredrik Sävje (external, Yale University) <i>Visiting Affiliation:</i> Harvard University, Ivy Plus Exchange Scholar (2019 - 2020)	<i>Ph.D., 2021</i>
University of Chicago Committee on International Relations (CIR)	<i>M.A.</i>
DePauw University Political Science	<i>B.A.</i>

PUBLISHED AND FORTHCOMING ARTICLES

- Leavitt, T. Beyond Pretrends: A Discordance-Based Sensitivity Analysis for Difference-in-Differences. Accepted at *Observational Studies*.
- Leavitt, T. and L. W. Miratrix. Building a Design-Based Matching Pipeline: From Principles to Practical Implementation in R. Accepted at *Observational Studies*.
- Leavitt, T. and V. Rivera-Burgos. (In press). Navigating the Mismeasurement of Intermediary Variables in Message-Based Experiments. *Political Science Research and Methods*, First View. DOI: 10.1017/psrm.2025.10082
- Leavitt, T. (2026). Fisher Meets Bayes: The Value of Randomisation for Bayesian Inference of Causal Effects. *International Statistical Review*, 94(1), 188-201. DOI: 10.1111/insr.12598
- Leavitt, T. and L. A. Hatfield. (2025). Averaged Prediction Models (APM): Identifying Causal Effects in Controlled Pre-Post Settings with Application to Gun Policy. *The Annals of Applied Statistics*, 19(3), 1826-1846. DOI: 10.1214/25-AOAS2011
- Leavitt, T. and V. Rivera-Burgos. (2024). Audit Experiments of Racial Discrimination and the Importance of Symmetry in Exposure to Cues. *Political Analysis*, 32(4), 445-462. DOI: 10.1017/pan.2024.3
- Leavitt, T. (2023). Randomization-Based, Bayesian Inference of Causal Effects. *Journal of Causal Inference*, 11(1), 20220025. DOI: 10.1515/jci-2022-0025

PUBLISHED BOOK CHAPTERS

Green, D. P., T. Leavitt, and D. Markovits (2023). Challenges that Proprietary Research Poses for Meta-Analysis. In J. M. Box-Steffensmeier, D. P. Christenson, and V. Sinclair-Chapman (Eds.), *Oxford Handbook of Engaged Methodological Pluralism in Political Science*, Volume 1, Chapter 18, pp. 257-271. New York, NY: Oxford University Press. Print edition 2026. DOI: 10.1093/oxfordhb/9780192868282.013.21

Bowers, J. and T. Leavitt (2020). Causality and Design-Based Inference. In L. Curini and R. Franzese (Eds.), *The SAGE Handbook of Research Methods in Political Science and International Relations*, Volume 2, Chapter 41, pp. 769-804. Thousand Oaks, CA: SAGE Publications. DOI: 10.4135/9781526486387.n44

ARTICLES UNDER REVIEW

Leavitt, T., J. Bowers, and L. W. Miratrix. Sequential Sensitivity Analysis for Multiple Assumptions: A Framework for Understanding Racial Disparity in Police Use of Force. Revise & resubmit at *Journal of the American Statistical Association*. arXiv:2605.21893

Leavitt, T. Which Effect of Race? Causal Inference without Holding All Else Equal. Submitted. arXiv:2607.16371

STATISTICAL SOFTWARE

Leavitt, T., Hatfield, L., & Greifer, N. (2025). *apm: Averaged Prediction Models*. R package version 0.1.1. DOI: 10.32614/CRAN.package.apm. Documentation: tl2624.github.io/apm/

OTHER WRITINGS

Zeldow, B., T. Leavitt and L. A. Hatfield. Difference-in-Differences. diff.healthpolicydatascience.org

TEACHING

Quantitative Methods 2: Statistical Theory and Causal Inference (Doctoral) S27
Political Science Department
Columbia University

Applied Quantitative Research II (Doctoral) F26
Political Science Department
The Graduate Center, CUNY

Causal Inference for the Social Sciences (Doctoral) Su18 - Su24; Su26
ICPSR Summer Program
University of Michigan

Data Collection and Description (Master's) S27
Marx School of Public and International Affairs
Baruch College, CUNY

Public Affairs Capstone Seminar (Master's) F26
Marx School of Public and International Affairs
Baruch College, CUNY

Advanced Quantitative Methods (Master's) F24, S25
Marx School of Public and International Affairs
Baruch College, CUNY

Causal Analysis and Inference (Master's) S24, F24, S25
Marx School of Public and International Affairs
Baruch College, CUNY

Data Analysis for Public Service (Master's) F23, S24
Marx School of Public and International Affairs
Baruch College, CUNY

* Note: S = Spring, F = Fall, Su = Summer; e.g., F24 = Fall 2024.

INVITED AND COMPETITIVE PRESENTATIONS

Invited Session “Robust Causal Inference Under Real-World Complications” SLDS 2026 Conference on Statistical Learning and Data Science ASA Section on Statistical Learning and Data Science	Nov 3, 2026 (Scheduled)
Data Science Frontiers: Society and Politics New York University (NYU) Abu Dhabi Institute NYU Abu Dhabi	Oct 15, 2025
Methods Workshop Department of Political Science Vanderbilt University	Nov 8, 2024
Data Science Cluster Meeting Baruch College, CUNY	Apr 17, 2024
Political Methodology Colloquium Department of Political Science Columbia University	Feb 23, 2024
Winter Workshop on Causal Inference and its Applications Departments of Statistics and Economics University of Florida	Jan 19, 2024
Department of Political Science Washington University in St. Louis	Oct 26, 2023
Invited Paper Session “Planning observational studies with unobserved confounding in mind” Joint Statistical Meetings	Aug 10, 2023
Data Science Lunch Seminar Series The Center for Data Science New York University	Mar 29, 2023
Conference of the ERCIM WG on Computational and Methodological Statistics (15th) CFE-CMStatistics King's College London	Dec 17, 2022
Applied Statistics Workshop The Institute for Quantitative Social Science Harvard University	Oct 12, 2022
Quantitative Methods Workshop Wilf Family Department of Politics New York University	Oct 4, 2022
Pre-APSA Workshop “Knowledge Accumulation and External Validity: Implications for Design and Analysis” Evidence in Governance and Politics (EGAP) Centre for the Study of Democratic Citizenship (CSDC) McGill University	Sep 14, 2022

The Miratrix C.A.R.E.S. Lab
Graduate School of Education and Department of Statistics
Harvard University

Mar 5, 2021

Columbia Business School and Chazen Institute for Global Business
Columbia University

Jan 29, 2020

Quantitative Methods Workshop
Wilf Family Department of Politics
New York University

Apr 1, 2019

SERVICE

Referee

The American Political Science Review; The American Statistician (2x); Journal of Causal Inference; Observational Studies; Philosophy of Science; Political Analysis (3x); Political Science Research and Methods; Statistics in Medicine

Marx School of Public and International Affairs

Assessor, Program Learning Assessment (HEA and MPA)
Member, Learning Assessment Committee
Peer Teaching Observer (PAF 9335, PAF 9134, PAF 4401)

AY 2025-26

AY 2023-24, 2024-25

F23, S24, F24

Columbia University

Coordinator, Methods Workshop
President, Political Science Graduate Student Council (PSGSC)
Coordinator, Contemporary African Political Economy Research Seminar (CAPERS)

AY 2016-17

AY 2015-16

Fall 2015

* Note: HEA = Higher Education Administration; MPA = Master of Public Administration.

ADDITIONAL TRAINING

HyFlex Seminar
Center for Teaching and Learning
Baruch College, CUNY

Spring, 2025

Seminar on Inclusive Pedagogy
Bernard L. Schwartz Communication Institute
Baruch College, CUNY

Spring, 2024

Understanding the Jewish Experiences and Antisemitism
NYC Commission on Human Rights

Jan 9, 2024

Human Rights Law, Racism and Other Forms of Discrimination Based on Race and Color
NYC Commission on Human Rights

Dec 5, 2023

At-Risk Mental Health for Faculty & Staff (Full)
Kognito

Sep 23, 2023

ICPSR Summer Program

University of Michigan

Maximum Likelihood Estimation I: Generalized Linear Models
Regression Analysis II: Linear Models
Introduction to Statistics and Data Analysis II
Introduction to Statistics and Data Analysis I

First Session, 2013

Second Session, 2012

Second Session, 2012

First Session, 2012

HONORS AND AWARDS

2024 Winter Workshop Travel Award
Department of Statistics and Department of Economics
University of Florida

2024

American Causal Inference Conference (ACIC) Junior Researcher Grant National Science Foundation (NSF)	2022
Dissertation Development Grant Department of Political Science Columbia University	2018
Proposal Development Grant The Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab (J-PAL) Massachusetts Institute of Technology	2017
Student Research Grant Center for Development Economics and Policy (CDEP) Columbia University	2016
Seed Grant Center for the Study of Development Strategies (CSDS) Columbia University	2015

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming	R, Stan,
Software	LaTeX, Mathematica

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

- American Political Science Association (APSA)
- Society for Political Methodology (SPM)
- Society for Causal Inference (SCI)